

Problem #4 (20 points). Here are some short dialogs in Engenni and their English translations:

1. *edèi âno nwasesè ozyí lèlemù à? edèi ânò wei ga òkí nwasese ozyí lèlemù.*
Will this man frighten the deceived thief?
This man said that he_{this man} would not frighten the deceived thief.
2. *avùrànmù kìnono amemùrè ânò à? avùrànmù wei ga òkí kìnono amemùrè ânò.*
Did the woman resemble this girl?
The woman said that she_{the woman} did resemble this girl.
3. *amó lèlemù ânó wuese avùrànmù à? amodhyòmù wei ga ò wuese avùrànmù.*
Did this deceived child not kill the woman?
The youth said that he_{this deceived child} did kill the woman.
4. *edèi dhia gbúnonò amò à? avùrànmù kofilomù wei ga o gbúnonò amò.*
Will the evil man heal the child?
The coughing woman said that he_{the evil man} would heal the child.
5. *amemùré dhiá kìnono opilopo ânò à? avùrànmù wei ga ò kìnono opilopo ânò.*
Did the evil girl not resemble this pig?
The woman said that she_{the evil girl} did not resemble this pig.
6. *ozyi gbunono okàá nɔamù ânò à? ozyi wei ga òkí gbunono okàá nɔamù ânò.*
Did the thief heal this beaten old man?
The thief said that he_{the thief} did not heal this beaten old man.
7. *ozyi âno kìnnonò edèi kofilomù à? amò ânò wei ga ò kìnnonò edèi kofilomù.*
Will this thief resemble the coughing man?
This child said that he_{this thief} would not resemble the coughing man.

(a) Translate into English:

8. *edèi ânò nwasese ozyi à? amemùrè wei ga ò nwasese ozyi.*
9. *amemùré lèlemu wúesè amodhyòmù ânò à?*
amemùré lèlemù wei ga òkí wúesè amodhyòmù ânò.

Here is also an answer in Engenni without a question for it:

10. *ozyi ânò wei ga amó gbunono edèi.*

Translate it into English. If it can be translated in more than one way, provide all translations and explain your reasoning.

(b) Translate into Engenni:

11. Will the old man resemble this coughing youth?
The child said that he_{the old man} would not resemble this coughing youth.
12. Did this beaten woman not frighten the man?
This beaten woman said that she_{this beaten woman} did not frighten the man.

(c) If you were to compile an Engenni dictionary, what would the base forms of the words ‘thief’ and ‘girl’ be? Explain your answer.

Twelfth International Olympiad in Linguistics (2014).
Individual Contest Problems

⚠ The Engenni language belongs to the Benue–Congo family. It is spoken by approx. 20,000 people in Nigeria.

The mark $\cdot$ underneath a word's first vowel indicates that all of the word's vowels are pronounced with a slightly lowered tongue. The marks $\acute{}$, $\grave{}$ and $\hat{}$ indicate high, low, and falling tone, respectively; if none is present, the syllable has middle tone.

—*Artūrs Semeņuks*